

# LINKS GOLF MAJOR

July 16–19, 2026 · Southport, England · \$1,000 Bankroll · fully deployed (6 outright + 5 top-10 props)

🚩 **ROUND 3 MID-ROUND — FOX & HERBERT STILL SHARE THE LEAD AT -8 · UPDATED SAT JUL 18, 6:15 PM UK (12:15 PM CT)**

**Deep into Moving Day, the top of the board is holding.** Two boards (Central Oregon Daily liveblog, updated 1:27 PM ET, + Golf Channel liveblog, both Jul 18 2026) agree: **Ryan Fox remains in the clubhouse at -8** after the record-tying 62, with **Lucas Herbert (-8) alongside him** as he works through his round. The chase pack: **Suber, Young and Gerard at -6**, then **DeChambeau, Burns and Si Woo Kim at -5**. Our card: **Scheffler, Rahm and Fleetwood all still -4 (T10)** in mid-round — nobody on our ticket has made the Saturday move yet — with **Justin Thomas also -4 through nine** and Schauffele in at -4 off a 66. **Morikawa sits back at -2** and 🏆 **Koepka languishes at +1** — nine off the lead, the +5000 ticket is on life support. Fitzpatrick's missed cut stands as \$150 dead money. **Nothing grades until Sunday's final putt** — tonight's finish tells us who's in Sunday range.

**156 players**

FIELD · 4 ROUNDS

**Royal Birkdale**

FIRST OPEN HERE SINCE  
2017

**Scheffler**

DEFENDING CHAMPION

**R3 LIVE**

FINAL ROUND SUNDAY ·  
GRADES SUN NIGHT

🚩 **HOW THIS CARD WORKS — TWO-PHASE BUILD**

Golf majors settle over four days against a 156-man field — even the favorite is only ~15% to win, so an outright card is a **basket of longshots by nature**. Phase 1: \$600 across six outright, odds locked at build. Phase 2 (deployed Wednesday, before the first tee): **\$400 across five top-10 finish props** on our basket players — the higher-probability side of golf betting, where a top-10 cashes when our guy merely contends rather than has to win outright.

## OUTRIGHT BOARD (DK / CONSENSUS AT BUILD)

|                                       |              |                                    |              |
|---------------------------------------|--------------|------------------------------------|--------------|
| <b>Scottie Scheffler</b> (def. champ) | <b>+450</b>  | <b>Rory McIlroy</b>                | <b>+750</b>  |
| <b>Jon Rahm</b>                       | <b>+1600</b> | <b>Tommy Fleetwood</b> (Southport) | <b>+1600</b> |
| <b>Xander Schauffele</b> ('24 champ)  | <b>+1600</b> | <b>Matt Fitzpatrick</b>            | <b>+2000</b> |
| <b>Cameron Young</b>                  | <b>+2500</b> | <b>Collin Morikawa</b> ('21 champ) | <b>+2800</b> |
| <b>Viktor Hovland</b>                 | <b>+3000</b> | <b>Brooks Koepka</b>               | <b>+5000</b> |

## THE ANGLES

### SCHEFFLER +450 · THE ANCHOR

WORLD NO. 1 · DEFENDING OPEN CHAMPION

- ▶ Best player alive, though winless in 13 starts — the price got longer than his true chance
- ▶ Opened +400, drifted to +450; markets over-punish "droughts" for elite iron players
- ▶ Links golf rewards flushed irons + flighted wedges — his exact profile

**Est. win: 18%** vs ~15% market — the rare positive-EV favorite

### FLEETWOOD +1600 · THE HOMETOWN STORY WITH TEETH

BORN IN SOUTHPORT — BIRKDALE IS LITERALLY HIS HOME COURSE

- ▶ Grew up playing Royal Birkdale; no player knows these dunes better
- ▶ Elite links pedigree: multiple top-fives in Opens, best ball-striking season of his career
- ▶ The narrative price and the golf price agree for once

**Est. win: 7%** vs 5.9% market

### THE ENGLISH CONTINGENT

FITZPATRICK +2000 · HOME MAJOR MOTIVATION

- ▶ Fitzpatrick: three wins this season, best year of his career, home country major
- ▶ Knock: 94th in strokes-gained putting — links greens neutralize that gap
- ▶ Rahm +1600: two-time major champ, near-misses at both 2026 majors, built for wind

**Rahm est. 7% · Fitzpatrick est. 5.5%** — both above market

### MORIKAWA + THE LONGSHOT

PROVEN OPEN WINNERS AT LONG PRICES

- ▶ Morikawa +2800: 2021 Open champion, just shot a Sunday 61 at Travelers
- ▶ Koepka +5000: five majors, big-game hunter, priced at career-long odds
- ▶ Majors are where Koepka's focus shows up — 50/1 is a stats-vs-narrative bet

**Morikawa est. 4.5% · Koepka est. 2.5%** — the 🏆 longshot lives here

## \$1,000 BANKROLL ALLOCATION

TOTAL BUDGET

**\$1,000**

\$600 on 6 outright + \$400 on 5 top-10 props · fully deployed

BASKET COVERAGE

**~44%**

chance one of our six lifts the Claret Jug

★ PHASE 1 · OUTRIGHT WINNER BASKET (MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE — MAX ONE CASHES)

| PICK                                                                                        | ODDS         | STAKE        | EST. WIN                | TO WIN             | TYPE             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|-------------------------|--------------------|------------------|
| <b>1 · Scottie Scheffler</b><br>Defending champ · drought discount on the best player alive | <b>+450</b>  | <b>\$200</b> | <b>18%</b><br>mkt 15%   | <b>+\$900.00</b>   | <b>ANCHOR</b>    |
| <b>2 · Jon Rahm</b><br>Two majors · near-misses all season · wind player                    | <b>+1600</b> | <b>\$100</b> | <b>7%</b><br>mkt 5.9%   | <b>+\$1,600.00</b> | <b>VALUE</b>     |
| <b>3 · Tommy Fleetwood</b><br>Southport native — Birkdale is his home course                | <b>+1600</b> | <b>\$100</b> | <b>7%</b><br>mkt 5.9%   | <b>+\$1,600.00</b> | <b>HOME TURF</b> |
| <b>4 · Matt Fitzpatrick</b><br>3 wins this season · English home major                      | <b>+2000</b> | <b>\$80</b>  | <b>5.5%</b><br>mkt 4.8% | <b>+\$1,600.00</b> | <b>VALUE</b>     |
| <b>5 · Collin Morikawa</b><br>2021 Open champ · Sunday 61 at Travelers                      | <b>+2800</b> | <b>\$70</b>  | <b>4.5%</b><br>mkt 3.4% | <b>+\$1,960.00</b> | <b>VALUE</b>     |
| <b>6 · 🏆 Brooks Koepka</b><br>The longshot — 5 majors, career-long price, big-game DNA      | <b>+5000</b> | <b>\$50</b>  | <b>2.5%</b><br>mkt 2%   | <b>+\$2,500.00</b> | <b>LONGSHOT</b>  |

PHASE 2 · TOP-10 PROPS · DEPLOYED WED JUL 15 · \$400

|                                                                                             |             |              |                       |                  |               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------------|-----------------------|------------------|---------------|
| <b>7 · Scottie Scheffler — Top 10</b><br>World No. 1 / +620 favorite · safest of the basket | <b>-146</b> | <b>\$120</b> | <b>62%</b><br>mkt 59% | <b>+\$82.19</b>  | <b>ANCHOR</b> |
| <b>8 · Tommy Fleetwood — Top 10</b><br>Southport native · Birkdale is his home links        | <b>+158</b> | <b>\$90</b>  | <b>44%</b><br>mkt 39% | <b>+\$142.20</b> | <b>VALUE</b>  |
| <b>9 · Jon Rahm — Top 10</b><br>Elite wind player · value vs the field                      | <b>+172</b> | <b>\$80</b>  | <b>42%</b><br>mkt 37% | <b>+\$137.60</b> | <b>VALUE</b>  |
| <b>10 · Matt Fitzpatrick — Top 10</b><br>English · six straight cuts made at The Open       | <b>+164</b> | <b>\$70</b>  | <b>42%</b><br>mkt 38% | <b>+\$114.80</b> | <b>VALUE</b>  |
| <b>11 · Collin Morikawa — Top 10</b><br>2021 Open champ · elite ballstriker for links       | <b>+280</b> | <b>\$40</b>  | <b>30%</b><br>mkt 26% | <b>+\$112.00</b> | <b>VALUE</b>  |

**Portfolio note.** The six outright are mutually exclusive — at most one cashes, but any one of them pays for the entire card several times over (Scheffler +\$900 minimum, Koepka +\$2,500 maximum). Combined coverage: ~44% that one of ours wins the Jug. The \$400 Phase 2 deployment — five top-10 props across the basket — is the higher-probability hedge: a top-10 cashes when our guy contends, not only when he lifts the Jug. Scheffler's is near-even money; the other four carry plus-money value. **McIlroy +750 is our biggest deliberate fade** — playing too infrequently this year to trust at half Fleetwood's price.

## ALLOCATION SUMMARY

**\$1,000**

FULLY DEPLOYED

**11**

BETS (6 + 5 PROPS)

**~44%**

BASKET COVERAGE

**+\$2,500**

BEST SINGLE PAYOUT

Fictitious \$1,000 bankroll test — no real money wagered. For entertainment purposes only.

Odds: DraftKings / consensus boards + Golf Digest reporting, locked at build (Sun Jul 12). Phase 2 props added Wednesday Jul 15.

Settlement Sunday Jul 19 · tracked in betting\_tracker.xlsx, tab "The Open".